

04 Aug 2026 01:48:48 ET | 12 pages

HSBC Holdings PLc (HSBA.L)

2Q26 Revenue Driven Beat & Improved NII Guide vs Lower Buyback & Some Cost Slippage

CITI'S TAKE

2Q26 underlying PBT (excl. notable items) of US\$10.3bn is 5% ahead of company-collected consensus, with revenues 2% ahead, costs in-line and impairments 1% lighter. The revenue beat is driven more by non-NII (4% ahead), led by Wealth, than Banking NII (1% ahead). Reported PBT of US\$10.1bn is 7% above consensus. CET1R of 14.1% is 10bps shy of consensus, despite a buyback of only US\$1.0bn (vs cons. US\$2.2bn). FY26 targets are updated, with higher NII guidance offset by heavier potential cost guidance and incremental investment expected in FY27 too. While the better NII is already captured in consensus, the heavier cost spend is arguably not. Importantly the bank is already generating a 19.5% RoTE this quarter, well ahead of medium-term guidance of >17%. Overall a mixed set of results. We have a Buy rating.

FY26 Guidance Update & New FY27 Commentary — Updated FY26 guidance is as follows: (1) Improved Banking NII >\$46bn (from ~\$46bn; vs consensus \$46.5bn). (2) Adjusted cost growth of 1% on target basis is unchanged, implying ~\$34.2bn, but is now caveated that 'increasing variable pay may increase costs modestly' (vs consensus \$34.3bn). (3) Loan loss ratio ~45bps (unchanged; vs consensus 45bps). The three medium-term targets are unchanged: (1) Revenue growth to rise to 5% by 2028 (vs consensus ~4.6% p.a.). (2) RoTE, ex notable items, to be 17% or better over 2026-28 (vs consensus 17.7-18.8%). (3) CET1 ratio 14.0-14.5% and 50% dividend payout (vs consensus 50-52%). HSBC has also introduced new FY27 cost commentary, namely 'will consider accelerating [investment] initiatives to support future growth, with 2027 cost growth part offset by organizational simplification'. Consensus is currently for 3% cost growth in 2027 to \$35.4bn, broadly in-line with inflation.

Capital Miss, Lower Buyback, Divestments Update — CET1 ratio of 14.1% is +10bps

HSBC Holdings PLc (USD)

Year to 31 Dec	2024A	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E
Net Income (\$M)	23,035.0	21,246.0	28,468.9	33,552.2	35,606.9
Diluted EPS (¢)	124.6	121.1	165.5	201.2	221.2
Diluted EPS (Old) (¢)	124.6	121.1	165.5	201.2	221.2
PE (x)	17.2	17.7	13.0	10.7	9.7
P/BV (x)	2.3	2.1	2.0	1.9	1.7
DPS (¢)	87.0	75.0	87.1	100.6	111.9
Net Div Yield (%)	4.1	3.5	4.1	4.7	5.2
ROE (%)	13.8	12.3	16.0	18.5	18.8

qoq and 10bps below consensus, as profit generation (+100bps) is offset by dividend accrual (-50bps), RWA growth (-30bps), and others (-10bps). New buyback of \$1.0bn is below consensus \$2.2bn. Slides 28-29 includes an update on divestments

Buy

Price (03 Aug 26 16:30)	£15.97
Target price	£16.40
Expected share price return	2.7%
Expected dividend yield	4.7%
Expected total return	7.4%
Market Cap	£274,422M US\$368,589M

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including recently announced Singapore Insurance (\$1.8bn gain) and Egypt retail (\$0.3bn gain).

Banking NII In-Line — Banking NII of \$11.6bn is +3% qoq and is broadly in-line with consensus after adjusting for \$0.1bn one-off benefit. NII qoq growth was driven by higher day count (\$0.1bn), volume growth, hedges roll-over, and aforementioned one-off. Structural hedge notional increased \$33bn qoq to \$637bn.

Non-NII Beat on Wealth (Again) — Non-NII of \$7.4bn is +7% yoy and 4% ahead of consensus. Wealth non-NII is +21% yoy ccy, driven by investment distribution (+26% yoy), Private Bank (+22% yoy), and Insurance (+21% yoy). Wealth balances are +2% qoq after adjusting for reclassification of \$18bn wealth balances from Singapore insurance, Indo retail, and Malta. NNM is \$25bn in 2Q26, flat yoy. Transaction banking non-NII is +7% yoy ccy with broad-based growth across securities service (+16% yoy), GTS (+7% yoy), GPS (+6% yoy), and FX (+5% yoy).

Costs In-Line — Underlying opex of \$8.4bn (+2% yoy, -1% qoq) is in-line with consensus, even as gross simplification save target has been increased to ~\$2bn (from \$1.5bn) o/w \$1.7bn achieved to-date. Investment spends continued in technology and strategic initiatives, largely offset by simplification savings and efficiency measures.

Impairments Small Beat — Loan losses of \$1.1bn is 1% lighter (or better) than consensus (loan loss ratio 41bps, -11bps qoq). This includes \$0.4bn provisions on HK CRE, \$0.3bn UK and \$0.2bn Mexico. HK CRE (excl. exposure to mainland China borrowers) is now down to \$29.3bn o/w \$8.5bn is deemed substandard or impaired and ECL is \$1.1bn.

Conference Call — 7:45 am UKT / 2:45 pm HKT. Webcast: [Link](#)

Implications — On balance the better non-NII print is likely to be offset by the heavy cost guide and lower buyback, leaving consensus EPS broadly unchanged. Key questions for the call: (1) What does the new 2027 cost commentary mean in quantitative terms? (2) Is the bank transitioning to lower quarterly buybacks, or is this quarters re-launch a stepping stone?

HSBC Holdings PLC

Valuation

We value HSBC using a two-stage dividend discount model (DDM) with 3% terminal growth. We then cross-reference this against peer group multiples. Our DDM uses our 2028E RoTE of 20.1% and 11.1% CoE. Our DDM points to a target price of 1,640p.

Risks

There are several risks that could cause the shares to fail to reach our target price including: [1] Economic and growth risks; [2] Competition and margin weakness; [3] Credit cost normalization; [4] Financial market volatility; [5] Regulatory risks; [6] Restructuring risk; [7] Geopolitical risks. Alternatively, should any of these risks prove more benign than we anticipate, this could drive upside to our target price.

HSBC Holdings Plc

(0005.HK; HK\$168.2; 1; 03 Aug 26; 16:10)

Valuation

We value HSBC using a two-stage dividend discount model (DDM) with 3% terminal growth. We then cross-reference this against peer group multiples. Our DDM uses our 2028E RoTE of 20.1% and 11.1% CoE. Our DDM points to a target price of HK\$171.8.

Risks

There are several risks that could cause the shares to fail to reach our target price including: [1] Economic and growth risks; [2] Competition and margin weakness; [3] Credit cost normalization; [4] Financial market volatility; [5] Regulatory risks; [6] Restructuring risk; and [7] Geopolitical risks. Alternatively, should any of these risks prove more benign than we anticipate, this could drive upside to our target price.

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Appendix A-1

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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

HSBC Holdings PLC (HSBA.L)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Andrew Coombs, CFA



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 10-Aug-23 20:38:40	1	*8.30	6.17
2 16-Oct-23 00:01:10	1	*8.80	6.36
3 30-Oct-23 15:44:17	1	*9.40	5.74
4 21-Dec-23 07:11:47	1	*8.80	6.08
5 12-Feb-24 12:08:02	1	*8.50	5.94
6 29-Feb-24 01:47:38	1	*8.10	6.00
7 22-Apr-24 14:27:28	1	*8.30	6.51
8 07-May-24 13:19:14	1	*7.80	6.96
9 07-Jul-24 22:30:00	1	*7.50	6.74

*Indicates Change

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
10 05-Aug-24 00:00:26	1	*8.40	6.26
11 16-Oct-24 00:03:31	1	*8.20	6.73
12 06-Nov-24 00:00:27	1	*8.90	7.24
13 10-Feb-25 13:02:37	1	*9.60	8.66
14 06-Mar-25 00:00:46	1	*10.70	8.81
15 25-Apr-25 14:01:44	1	*9.90	8.34
16 03-Jun-25 00:30:00	1	*9.70	8.76
17 18-Jul-25 02:07:27	1	*10.10	9.33
18 22-Sep-25 00:00:42	1	*11.20	10.32

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
19 20-Oct-25 06:56:20	1	*11.60	9.70
20 28-Oct-25 13:19:26	1	*12.40	10.50
21 08-Jan-26 08:43:35	1	*13.20	11.95
22 27-Jan-26 00:00:49	1	*13.70	12.77
23 26-Feb-26 01:44:47	1	*15.40	13.98
24 09-Apr-26 00:00:41	1	*14.70	13.34
25 15-Jul-26 11:45:08	1	*16.40	14.80

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

HSBC Holdings Plc (0005.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Andrew Coombs, CFA



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	11-Aug-23 04:58:01	1	*82.25	61.14
2	16-Oct-23 00:01:10	1	*83.84	60.36
3	30-Oct-23 15:44:32	1	*89.40	55.87
4	21-Dec-23 07:17:59	1	*86.90	59.82
5	12-Feb-24 06:03:48	1	*83.90	59.92
6	29-Feb-24 01:47:38	1	*80.00	58.85
7	22-Apr-24 14:27:28	1	*80.50	61.92
8	07-May-24 13:19:14	1	*76.20	68.08
9	07-Jul-24 22:30:00	1	*74.00	67.80

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
10	05-Aug-24 00:00:26	1	*84.20	62.05
11	16-Oct-24 00:03:31	1	*83.30	67.70
12	06-Nov-24 00:00:27	1	*89.80	72.35
13	10-Feb-25 13:02:37	1	*93.10	82.60
14	06-Mar-25 00:00:46	1	*105.10	90.00
15	25-Apr-25 14:01:44	1	*102.10	85.35
16	03-Jun-25 00:30:00	1	*103.00	92.15
17	18-Jul-25 02:07:27	1	*106.20	98.15
18	31-Jul-25 12:34:57	1	*105.60	96.15

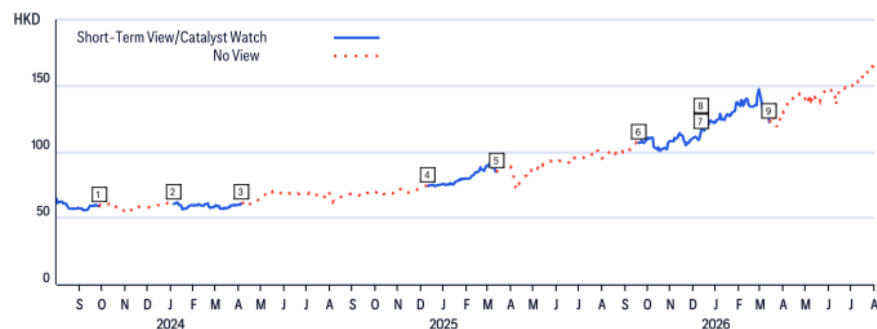
	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
19	22-Sep-25 00:00:42	1	*118.20	107.20
20	20-Oct-25 06:56:20	1	*120.90	102.10
21	28-Oct-25 13:19:01	1	*127.80	106.50
22	08-Jan-26 08:45:42	1	*138.30	124.30
23	27-Jan-26 00:00:49	1	*143.30	134.50
24	26-Feb-26 01:48:35	1	*163.30	145.00
25	09-Apr-26 00:00:41	1	*153.40	138.90
26	11-May-26 03:35:28	1	*156.70	141.20
27	15-Jul-26 11:45:08	1	*171.80	155.30

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

HSBC Holdings Plc (0005.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Andrew Coombs, CFA



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	27-Sep-23 00:15:31	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	59.43
2	07-Jan-24 19:00:54	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	60.90
3	05-Apr-24 12:04:21	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	61.29

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
4	10-Dec-24 19:05:44	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	74.20
5	12-Mar-25 00:14:40	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	85.05
6	21-Sep-25 20:00:42	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	106.80

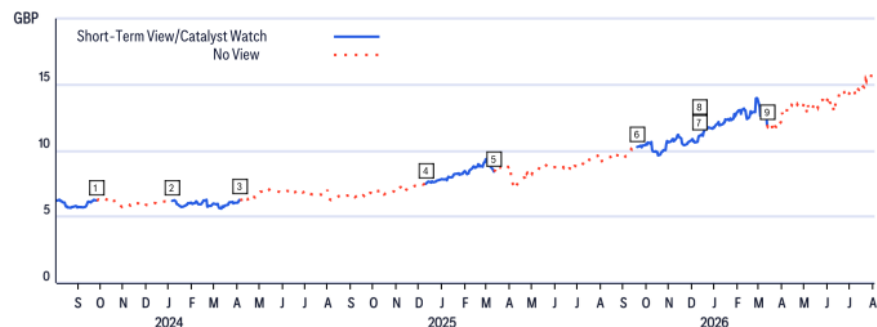
	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
7	11-Dec-25 19:05:26	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	114.00
8	11-Dec-25 19:05:26	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	114.00
9	13-Mar-26 00:16:27	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	122.50

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

HSBC Holdings PLC (HSBA.L)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Andrew Coombs, CFA



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	26-Sep-23 07:37:41	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	6.24
2	07-Jan-24 19:00:57	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	6.20
3	05-Apr-24 12:03:27	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	6.26

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
4	10-Dec-24 19:05:59	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	7.50
5	11-Mar-25 08:44:34	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	8.42
6	21-Sep-25 20:00:42	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	10.28

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
7	11-Dec-25 19:05:12	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	11.13
8	11-Dec-25 19:05:12	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	11.13
9	12-Mar-26 08:46:27	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	11.96

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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Data current as of 01 Jul 2026	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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